

CAREER PATHS

A master's degree and professional license is necessary to practice as an occupational therapist. The work is highly varied with opportunities to specialize in different areas or to progress into management, research, or teaching. Some experienced therapists choose to take up roles in industry or to establish themselves in private practice.

ASSISTANT After graduating high school, you can support a qualified therapist while studying for a degree.

GRADUATE You must earn a bachelor's degree in occupational therapy and pass the national exam before you can practice.



OCCUPATIONAL THERAPIST Assesses their clients and draws up suitable treatment plans, then works with them to achieve their targets.



ORTHOPEDIC OCCUPATIONAL THERAPIST Works as part of a health care team, helping patients recover after surgery on, or injury to, bones and muscles.



PEDIATRIC OCCUPATIONAL THERAPIST Works with children with developmental issues. May travel to schools to assess children and consult with teachers on appropriate activities.



PSYCHIATRIC OCCUPATIONAL THERAPIST Helps people adjust to living with mental health issues and learning disabilities.



GERIATRIC OCCUPATIONAL THERAPIST Assists elderly clients with age-related problems and medical conditions, such as dementia, impaired vision or hearing, and poor mobility.

SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent communication skills in order to interact with patients and other people in medical care.



The willingness to work in a team with other medical and social service staff.



The ability to be sensitive and empathize with people who have physical and emotional problems.



Good decision-making and organizational skills to prioritize and manage case loads.



Patience and perseverance in assisting patients unwilling to accept help.



Physical strength and stamina to lift heavy equipment and help maneuver patients.